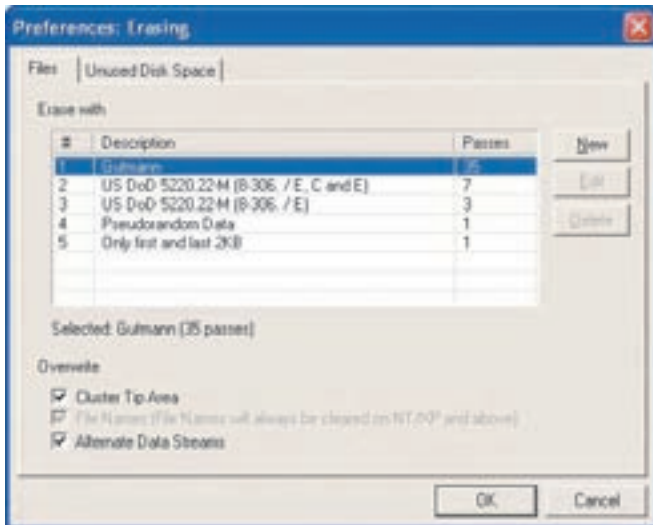


more than random numbers or a series of zeroes and ones bit patterns.

Freeraser: Free Shredder is a Windows file shredding utility that wipes files in all three of the above methods and is good for basic use. It even places a fancy recycle bin icon that prompts a warning message any time you drag any data to it. Eraser Secure Data Removal Tool goes even further by can also erase space allocated to the file by the OS (called file slack space), Windows virtual memory swap files, unused space on a hard disk or an entire hard disk and also erasing filenames from the directories. It can wipe any amount of data specified and even supports the three above erasure methods. It's also open source and works perfectly with Windows.

Let's say you want to completely wipe your hard disk, when giving away your computer to someone for example. No other software is best suited for bulk emergency destruction than Darik's Boot and Nuke, referred to as DBAN for short. It comes in the form of bootable CDROM image and once loaded proceeds to completely destroy data in every partition and hard disk.



Erasing data securely